Northwind Logistics Employee Handbook 2026

1. Welcome to Northwind Logistics

This handbook explains how we work together at Northwind Logistics. It applies to all permanent and fixed-term employees in Europe from 1 January 2026. Where local law gives you more favourable terms, local law applies. Questions about this handbook can be sent to the People Team at people@northwind.example.

2. Working hours

The standard working week is 37.5 hours, usually Monday to Friday. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 local time; outside those hours you may organise your day freely as long as your team agrees. Overtime must be approved in advance by your manager and is compensated either with time off in lieu (1.25 hours per hour worked) or paid at 125% of the hourly rate.

3. Remote and hybrid work

Most office-based roles are hybrid. Employees may work remotely up to three days per week, agreed with their manager. Warehouse and fleet roles are on-site by nature and are not eligible for regular remote work.

Working from another country is allowed for up to 20 working days per calendar year. You must request it at least two weeks in advance and obtain approval from both your manager and the People Team, because tax and social security rules can apply. Working from a country under international sanctions is never permitted.

Remote workers receive a home-office allowance of 30 EUR per month, paid with salary, to cover internet and electricity.

4. Paid time off

New full-time employees receive 25 days of paid vacation per year, in addition to public holidays. After five years of service the allowance rises to 28 days. Part-time employees receive a pro-rated allowance based on their contracted hours.

Vacation accrues at 2.08 days per month of employment. Up to 5 unused days may be carried over into the next year, but carried-over days must be taken before 31 March or they are lost. Requests of more than 5 consecutive days should be submitted at least four weeks in advance in the HR portal.

5. Sick leave

If you are ill, tell your manager before 10:00 on the first day of absence. A medical certificate is required from the fourth consecutive day of sickness. Northwind tops up statutory sick pay to 100% of base salary for up to 60 calendar days per year.

6. Parental leave

Birthing parents receive 20 weeks of fully paid parental leave. Non-birthing parents, including adoptive parents, receive 12 weeks of fully paid leave that can be taken in up to three blocks within the first 18 months. A phased return of four weeks at 80% working time and 100% pay is offered after any parental leave.

7. Expenses and travel

Business expenses must be submitted in the expense tool with a receipt within 30 days of being incurred. Expenses submitted later than 90 days will not be reimbursed.

Category	Limit	Notes
Meals while travelling	45 EUR per day	Alcohol is not reimbursed
Hotel	160 EUR per night	220 EUR in London, Paris and Zurich
Train	Standard class	First class for journeys over 4 hours
Flights	Economy	Must be booked through the travel portal
Mileage (own car)	0.30 EUR per km	Only when no train option exists

8. Equipment

Every employee receives a laptop, a headset and, for hybrid roles, a monitor for home use. Equipment remains company property and must be returned within 5 working days of your last day. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to the IT Service Desk within 24 hours.

9. Information security

Multi-factor authentication is mandatory on all company accounts. Never share passwords, including with colleagues or IT staff. Customer data may only be stored in approved systems; copying customer data to personal devices or personal cloud storage is a serious breach of policy. Suspected phishing emails should be reported with the Report button in the mail client.

10. Code of conduct

We expect respectful, honest behaviour toward colleagues, customers and partners. Gifts from suppliers worth more than 50 EUR must be declared to your manager. Concerns about misconduct can be raised confidentially through the Speak Up line, and retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith is prohibited.